



Brand strategy & tone of voice

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Our brand strategy

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01

Why our brand matters

Our brand shapes the expectations people have of KPMG. Whether it's a candidate considering joining us, an organization deciding to work with us or an existing client extending their relationship with us, the reputation of the KPMG brand informs stakeholder decisions and action. Similarly, brand provides focus for our own decision making, driving efficiency and supporting innovation. For these reasons we invest in our brand, maintaining it as an asset and strategic lever for driving growth. A strong KPMG brand helps us capture market share from our competition, be known for the full extent of our services and create more impact for our communities. We can be proud of the KPMG brand and we are all committed to delivering on it.

02

Our brand strategy



Positioning statement

Every day, enterprises see increasing complexity, conflicting choices and infinite information.

We see a world of opportunity—one where enterprises and individuals have the insights they need to build trust, transform and succeed. From uncovering ways to digitize the audit, to enabling new sectors to take off, to building sustainability and resilience into economies, we know insights reveal new opportunities for all.

Our role is to bring to bear innovative technologies and processes that translate insights into action. Whatever the challenge, we'll convene the right people to face it. Diverse and dedicated problem solvers, connected by a common cause. Experts tailoring data-driven solutions and shaping intelligent systems. Teams sparking outcomes that align with your values, build trust with your stakeholders and accelerate your transformation. Because when people and technology are in harmony, opportunity is everywhere.

Short-form statements

KPMG. From insights to opportunities.	Insights can lead to new opportunities for all.	When insights drive action, great outcomes happen.	Let's uncover a world of opportunity together.
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Brand attributes

Insightful	Inclusive	Passionate	Outcomes-driven
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We’ve refreshed our brand attributes to reflect our new positioning. Think of our attributes as the traits that describe what we’re like as people, consultants and colleagues. They express the qualities we bring to each engagement.

Our brand attributes work alongside our brand values and voice principles to define who we are as an organization. Our values convey what we believe and guide how we act. Our voice principles describe how we sound and shape how we write. Our brand attributes help us complete the picture, so to speak, by underscoring what makes a KPMG experience unique.

Insightful	Inclusive	Passionate	Outcomes-driven
We reveal unseen opportunity by bringing global expertise and innovative thinking to everything we do	We bring together diverse perspectives and skills, because this leads to deeper insights and greater outcomes	We’re driven by a desire to help people realize opportunities and earn the trust of our stakeholders	We work shoulder to shoulder with our clients to help them achieve better outcomes

What our brand positioning means for KPMG

Our brand positioning reflects our unique strengths as KPMG, and what our stakeholders are looking for and value.

We know that insights are fundamental because they illuminate new opportunities. And with KPMG's help, people can act on those insights, realize opportunities and achieve new outcomes.

Single-minded and tangible, the positioning provides us with a clear focus. It speaks to our technology and people agenda. It helps us to grow established services like audit, just as it accelerates our success in newer areas like ESG.

The positioning is designed to help inform and guide our client and people experience. Part of that experience is communications, but most of it is in our everyday interactions. It requires us to invest in insights across our systems, processes and behaviors. And to set high standards for quality, consistency and clarity.

Our brand positioning is what we want to be known for and how we work. While our brand positioning can change over time, it is always rooted in our Purpose like our Collective Strategy and our Values.

On the following pages, you will find guidance on how to use this work in your everyday life.

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01

Our insight framework

A KPMG insight is a concise expression of what's been learned based on facts. We then use these insights to illuminate new opportunities for organizations and individuals. And through KPMG's services, people can take the actions that will realize those opportunities.



Ideally, each KPMG insight should...

- Leverage data, preferably proprietary or unique to KPMG
- Provide a new perspective on an existing issue
- Present information in a way that helps inform better decisions
- Demonstrate an unexpected depth of understanding
- Reveal an unseen opportunity or connection

Use this checklist to strengthen an insight:

Intuitive but not obvious

Something readers can immediately see the value in, but not something they already knew or simply describing a client issue

✓ This:

The legalization of online sports betting has created new opportunities for the sports, media and gaming companies to grow, and the winners are those focused on fan-centric ecosystems.

✗ Not this:

The rapid increase in popularity and legalization of online sports betting is creating new opportunities for sports, media and gaming companies to grow.

Data-driven but not data-centric

Built from and supported by real evidence, but not just data on its own without interpretation

✓ This:

With two-thirds of executives at global corporations believing decarbonization efforts will adversely impact their workforce, there is an opportunity to mitigate internal resistance by instituting new decarbonization incentives for employees.

✗ Not this:

Nearly two-thirds of executives at global corporations anticipate some adverse impact from corporate decarbonization efforts on employees.

Specific but not inaccessible

Relevant to a particular subject area or stakeholder, but not difficult for a broader audience to understand

✓ This:

Firms with greater operational resilience are ones that have a deep understanding of how external stakeholders will respond to service disruptions, which helps them ensure trust and governance.

✗ Not this:

Firms with greater operational resilience are ones that have well-defined service-level thresholds and highly calibrated impact tolerances that inspire stakeholder trust and governance.

Actionable but not instructional

Sparking action and encouraging readers to engage with KPMG, but not a directive statement about what to do

✓ This:

Customers are more likely to trust organizations that invest in data security, placing a high value on a federated IT organization and partnerships with established industry leaders.

✗ Not this:

Companies should invest in data security and partner with established industry leaders to build trust among their customers and thrive in an increasingly digital landscape.

Inspiration for uncovering insights

Here are some places insights may be found:

Confluence of macrotrends The combination of macrotrends and their compounding effects <i>Convergence of industries, e.g., gaming, sports and media</i>	Anomalies Deviations within data that are a break from the year-over-year norm, or set a new precedent <i>An increase in green-labeled financial products and how firms should respond</i>	Challenging conventions Contradictions of accepted wisdom <i>Decarbonization is as much a human capital challenge as it is financial</i>
Pain points What are the moments or experiences that generate the most pain, and what is causing it? <i>Common challenges in risk management and KPMG's solutions</i>	The edges What are early adopters, extreme users and industry innovators doing that may become the "new normal"? <i>"Future of" industries and sectors</i>	Analogies What can X learn from Y? <i>Gaming advances leading to extended reality in the workplace</i>

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Voice principles

Our voice principles shape the distinct tone of our communications. We call this tone our “brand voice.” Together with our values and attributes, our voice helps us express the character and personality of our organization.

Our brand voice is one of the most powerful tools we have for bringing our brand strategy to life. When we communicate in a voice that’s unmistakably ours, we not only stand out among our peers — we create more immediate connections with our audiences. These connections make it easier for our audiences to hear and remember what we have to say, from the insights we deliver to the opportunities we point them toward.

Three principles define our voice: **smart**, **clear** and **confident**. They are long-standing voice principles of ours, but we’ve refreshed them so that they reflect our new strategy. Each principle captures an essential element of our writing style. When they’re used together, they create the tone of our communications, helping us deliver our new strategy in a voice that’s unique to KPMG. Our principles influence the words we choose, the sentences we build and the content we ultimately put out into the world.

The following pages provide detailed definitions of our voice principles. Each principle is paired with specific writing instruction. At the end of this section are a few examples of our voice principles in action.

Because our insights reveal new opportunities that people can realize.

This means that we:

Express ourselves with intelligence but never arrogance, bringing together the practical and the aspirational.

We sound:

Bright *but not* academic

Sharp *but not* slick

Thought-provoking *but not* confrontational

When we communicate, we:

Connect insight to opportunity.

Approach issues from fresh, thoughtful angles and spotlight the opportunities they reveal.

Think out loud.

Pose questions and be willing to hypothesize.

Show our work.

Share other expert insights and viewpoints that shaped our thinking.

Because we connect information directly to insight.

This means that we:

Express our ideas in ways that are transparent, elegant and accessible to all.

We sound:

Conversational *but not casual*

Simple *but not simplistic*

Precise *but not rigid*

When we communicate, we:

Organize and explain.

Break down information for a layperson's understanding.

Use everyday language.

Write with a natural, accessible style.

Get to the point.

Express our insights and points of view succinctly and unambiguously.

Because we have a distinct point of view and we're eager to share it with the world.

This means that we:

Express ourselves with certainty, positivity and an optimistic attitude.

We sound:

Bold *but not* brazen

Assertive *but not* aggressive

Expert *but not* arrogant

When we communicate, we:

Show conviction.

Convey confidence in our insights, backed by our experience and expertise.

Focus on the positive.

Reflect optimism about both immediate and future outcomes.

Highlight our successes.

Demonstrate our track record of connecting insight to opportunity with specific proof.

Our updated voice principles

Smart

Because our insights reveal new opportunities that people can realize.

We sound:

Bright *but not academic*

Sharp *but not slick*

Thought-provoking *but not confrontational*

Clear

Because we connect information directly to insight.

We sound:

Conversational *but not casual*

Simple *but not simplistic*

Precise *but not rigid*

Confident

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02

Voice principles in action

Example 1

Instead of this...

Sustainable finance continues to gain traction as pressure rapidly mounts from regulators, investors and customers to prioritize environmental, social and governance (ESG) criteria throughout the financial landscape. Putting sustainable financial principles into practice and operationalizing a more sustainable business model can offer many benefits, including better performance leading to greater access to capital, reducing risk and driving long-term value.

Try this

A sustainable business model yields a big upside: better performance. That means greater access to capital, reduced risk and stronger long-term value. Little wonder that customers, investors and regulators expect companies to prioritize environmental, social and governance (ESG). Sustainable finance practices are not only here to stay, they're shaping the future of business.

Because

- Leading with an insight and spotlighting the opportunity it offers clients shows how we're **smart**
- Breaking down information and embracing a more conversational approach shows how we're **clear**
- Framing the issue in positive terms while adapting an assertive, expert tone shows how we're **confident**

Example 2

Instead of this...

When businesses reopen their doors, will organizations go back to working the way they were? Or will they capitalize on the insights, improvements and investments recently made to advance the future of work?

At KPMG LLP, we help organizations enable more agile, data-driven approaches to empowering their people and business—no matter where they work. Learn how.

Try this

When businesses reopen their doors to a post-COVID world, they'll be faced with an incredible opportunity: advancing the future of work.

We can help your organization foster a more agile, data-driven approach to the workplace. Fueled by insights, we'll capitalize on the improvements and investments you made during the pandemic, so you can empower your people and your business from anywhere.

Because

- Spotlighting the opportunity that comes out of a challenging situation shows how we're **smart**
- Getting straight to the point in the opening paragraph shows how we're **clear**
- Focusing on the positive and quickly getting to our role in making it happen shows how we're **confident**

Contact

If you have any questions, please contact **Global Brand**.